

USING THE FIVE

Lighter, not colder

— **Soft white** replaces winter's greige on the walls — still warm, still doing almost nothing, but lifted. The danger is reaching for a true white, which goes cold the moment the spring light hits it.

— **Pale sage** is the new neutral. So desaturated it behaves like a grey, but with a green memory in it. A linen curtain in this tone is the single best spring change you can make.

— **Bleached oak** is the season's wood — lighter than winter's walnut, the colour of furniture left in the sun. If your wood is dark, you don't replace it; you add one pale piece to lighten the average.

— **Stone** stays, as it does all year — the unglazed ceramic where the eye rests.

— **First green** is the only accent, and it is alive. Not a green cushion. A single budding branch, cut from outside, changed each week. The room's one bright note has a stem and drinks water.

Replace nothing you can lighten. Spring is an adjustment, not a renovation.
